



Corporate climate ratings

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► To cite this version:

Marine Kohler, Pascal da Costa, François Cluzel, Loïc Umbricht. Corporate climate ratings. Journée de l'école doctorale 2025, Mar 2025, Paris, France. <hal-05074132>

HAL Id: hal-05074132

<https://hal.science/hal-05074132v1>

Submitted on 30 Jun 2025

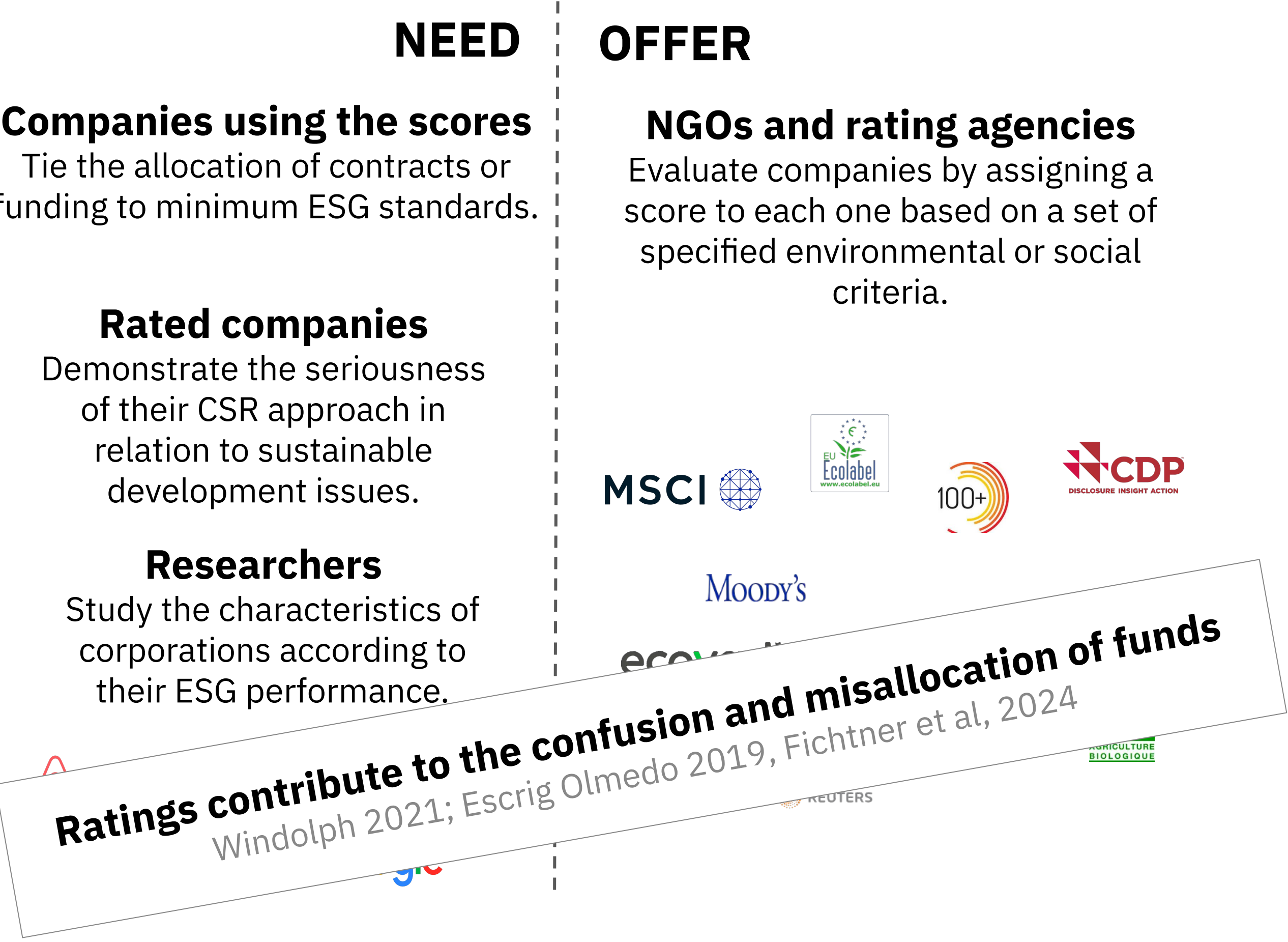
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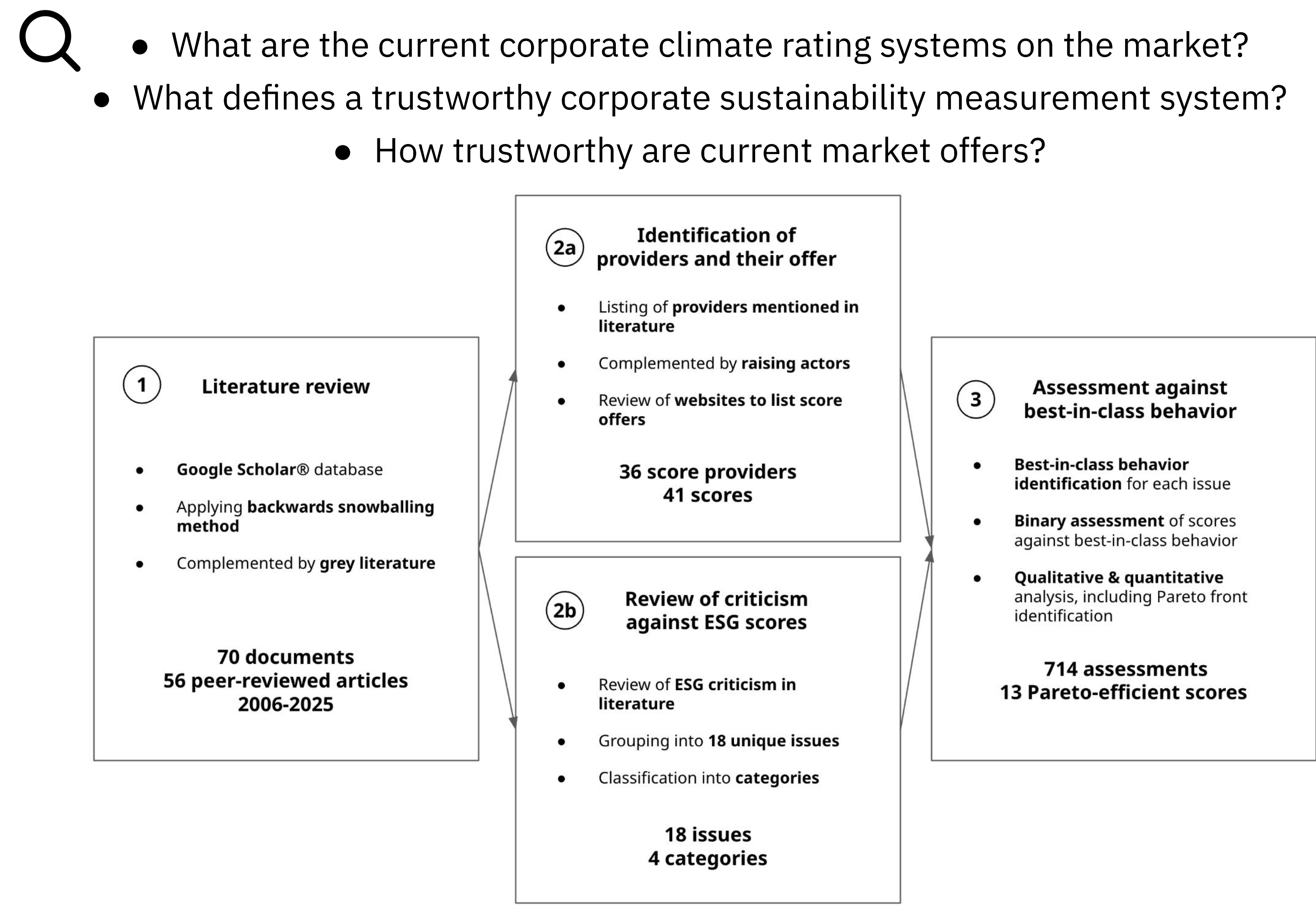


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The market of corporate climate ratings



Method



Results

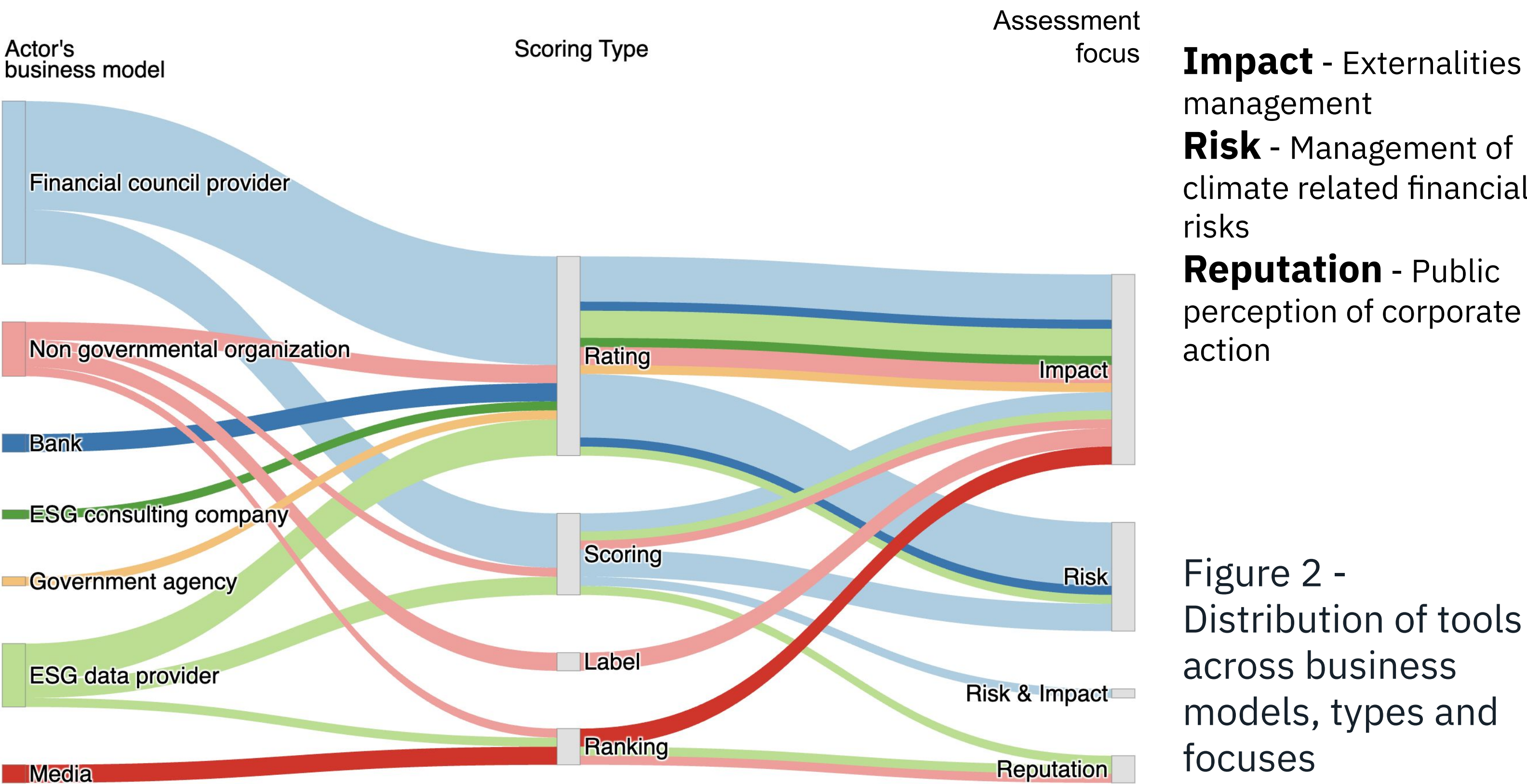
A range of identified concerns



Reliability - Deliver a consistent assessment
Accuracy - Provide correct information
Fairness - Show just treatment
Effectiveness - Drive improvements

Figure 1 - Scientific concerns according to number of mentions in our litterature corpus

A diversity of raters, tools and focuses



Impact - Externalities management
Risk - Management of climate related financial risks
Reputation - Public perception of corporate action

Figure 2 - Distribution of tools across business models, types and focuses

Actor	Scoring name	Criterion																Number of passing criteria
		Transparency	Independency	Standardisation	Verification	Weighting	Compensation	Relativity	Immateriality	Forward look	Stakeholders	Sector exclusion	Value chain	Regulation	Specificity	Progress	Support	
3BL Media	100 Best Corporate Citizens																	3
ADEME ACT Solutions	ACT rating																	9
Bank Sarasin & Co Ltd.	J. Safra Sarasin ESG Rating																	3
BLab	B Corp Label (2025 standard)																	12
Bloomberg	ESG Score																	7
Bloomberg	UN SDG Impact materiality																	8
Bloomberg	Various																	0
Carbon Disclosure Project	CDP Climate Score																	7
Carbone 4	Compatibility score with the Paris Agreement																	10
Carbone 4	Carbon Impact Analytics																	0
Climateaction100	Net Zero Company Benchmark																	9
Corporate Accountability	Corporate Hall of Shame																	2
Corporate Knights	The Global 100 list																	7
EcoVadis	Ecovadis Medals and Badges																	6
ECPI	Carbon rating																	7
ECPI	ESG Rating																	0
Ethifinance	Unavailable																	0
Fitch	ESG Vulnerability score																	0
FTSE Russel	FTSE ESG Scores																	7
Inrate	ESG impact ratings																	6
Insight Investment	Prime climate risk ratings																	6
Insight Investment	Prime ESG ratings																	7
ISS / Oekom	ESG Corporate Rating																	6
ISS / Oekom	Carbon Risk Rating																	0
JUST Capital	Annual JUST capital corporation ranking																	11
Moody's / Vigeo EIRIS	ESG risk score																	0
Moody's / Vigeo EIRIS	Climate risk score																	0
MorningStar / Sustainalytics	Low Carbon Transition Rating																	6
MorningStar / Sustainalytics	ESG Risk rating																	3
MorningStar / Sustainalytics	Physical risk rating																	6
MSCI / KLD / Innovest	MSCI Implied Temperature Rise																	6
MSCI / KLD / Innovest	MSCI ESG Rating																	4
Refinitiv / Asset4 / Thomson & Reuters	ESG Score																	2
RepRisk	RepRisk Index																	3
RepTrak	ESG Perception & Global RepTrak 100																	2
SAM / S&P Global / Trucost	S&P Global ESG Score																	7
SAM / S&P Global / Trucost	Climate Transition Assessment																	7
SBTi	Science Based Targets labels																	8
Sensefolio	Sensefolio ESG framework																	0
SSI	ESG Rating																	4
SSI	Carbon neutrality rating																	5
SynTao Green Finance	SynTao ESG Rating																	3
ZKB Sustainability Research	Swisscanto Sustainability rating																	5
Passing percentage (when issue is applicable)		29%	50%	12%	10%	19%	10%	36%	47%	48%	56%	10%	16%	62%	94%	68%	8%	24%
		The scoring passes the criterion The scoring does not pass the criterion There's partial evidence the scoring passes the criterion The criticism doesn't apply to the rating There is no public information available Pareto efficient actors																

Figure 3 - Result of the assessment of the identified scoring systems against best-in-class criteria

Opaque & misaligned systems

Most scoring systems go **beyond regulation**, adjust their criteria based on **company size, location, or industry**, and consider **value chain data**.
Only about 50% of scores are evaluated by an **independent financial entity** or anticipate **future corporate strategies**.
Data verification remains limited, **weightings** are often arbitrary, results allow for **compensation** between ESG criteria, and final results are **rarely absolute**.

Policy recommendations

- Enforce **transparency** on aggregation methods and practices implemented to address listed issues
- Enforce **minimum quality standards**
- Standardize** sustainability definitions
- Promote **government-led measurement systems**

Preprint

